IS 350 – Project Management

Project Proposal

Project Title : SmartOrder

Section : 6C2

Group No. 5

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Introduction :

Food delivery applications have become widely used in recent years, as they allow users to easily order food from different restaurants through their smartphones. One of the most popular food delivery applications in Saudi Arabia is Jahez [1], which provides users with access to a wide variety of restaurants, food options, and convenient delivery services.

Despite the many advantages offered by the Jahez application, there are still opportunities to improve the overall user experience. Many users, particularly university students, often look for more affordable meal options, better recommendations for similar food items across restaurants, and easier ways to place group orders with friends. However, the current version of the application does not fully support features that help users manage their budgets or organize shared orders efficiently.

Therefore, this project proposes an enhanced version of the Jahez application called SmartOrder. The goal of this project is to improve the user experience by introducing several new features, including student discounts, a budget selection feature that helps users find meals within their price range, a similar item recommendation feature across different restaurants, and a group ordering feature through a shared link. These improvements aim to make the application more convenient, user-friendly, and better suited to the needs of different types of users.

Problem Statement :

While the Jahez application has successfully established itself as a leading food delivery platform in Saudi Arabia , it currently functions as a general-purpose service that often overlooks the specific financial and social needs of frequent users, particularly university students. Through our analysis of the existing system, we identified several critical gaps that hinder the user experience and limit the app’s efficiency in real-world scenarios.

The core problems we aim to address with SmartOrder are:

Financial Barriers for Students: There is a lack of a dedicated verification system to offer consistent discounts for university students. This makes the app less accessible for a large demographic that relies on affordable dining options.

Absence of Budgetary Control: Users currently have no way to manage their spending within the app. Without a budget-tracking or selection feature, it is difficult for users to maintain financial discipline while ordering.

Inefficient Search and Discovery: When a specific item is unavailable or out of budget, the current interface does not provide an intelligent "Similar Items" recommendation. This forces users to restart their search manually, leading to a tedious user journey.

Social Coordination Challenges: Placing a group order in the existing app is a manual and disorganized process. There is no feature that allows a group of people to contribute to a single basket via a shared link, which often leads to errors and delays in group coordination.

To solve these issues, our project will enhance the Jahez model into SmartOrder. By integrating Student Discounts, Budget Selection, Similar Item Suggestions, and Group Orders via Links, we will provide a more personalized, intuitive, and cost-effective solution that aligns with the needs of modern users.

Methodology with justification :

This project will adopt the Incremental Software Development Model [2]. In this model, the system is developed and delivered in multiple increments, where each increment adds new functionality to the system.

Increment 1: Student Discount Feature.

The development of the student discount feature will begin with analyzing the requirements for verifying university students and identifying discount rules. The feature will then be designed, implemented, and tested to ensure that eligible students can receive special offers.

Increment 2: Budget Control Feature.

In this increment, the team will analyze how users can set a spending limit when ordering food. The feature will then be designed, implemented, and tested to ensure that users can effectively control their spending.

Increment 3: Similar Item Recommendation Feature.

This increment focuses on a similar item recommendation feature. The team will first analyze menu data and user preferences, then design, implement, and test a system that suggests alternative menu items based on price range or user preferences.

Increment 4: Smart Group Ordering via Shareable Link.

The final increment will introduce the smart group ordering feature. The team will analyze how multiple users can participate in one order through a shareable link, then design, implement, and test the feature to allow users to add items collaboratively with automatic bill splitting.

The incremental model is suitable for this project because the system enhancements can be implemented gradually, where each feature is developed as a separate increment. This allows the team to test and evaluate each functionality before adding the next one, leading to better project management, easier testing, and continuous improvement of the system.

Project charter :

In the other document

References :

[1] Jahez International Company, "Jahez Food Delivery Platform." [Online]. Available: https://jahez.net

[2] K. Schwalbe, *Information Technology Project Management*, 8th ed. Boston, MA, USA: Cengage Learning, 2016.